

To a National Spiritual Assembly

1994-07-25 • UHG • Nationale Geistige Räte

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1994-07-25

dear bahá'í friends,

concerning the extraordinary behavior of one of the delegates at your recent National convention.

how to deal with this situation would depend to some degree upon the

believer in question; for example, whether he is a new and inexperienced bahá'í or a long-time believer who would be expected to know better. This

is a matter within your jurisdiction, but if you require any further advice

provide it with more detailed information. in general it would, of course, be

desirable for you to try to clarify the principles for this friend and help him

to understand his responsibilities. At the same time you will wish to try to

ascertain the reasons for his behavior so that you can assist him to overcome

his problems.

To assist you in consulting with this friend, we enclose a few extracts

from passages relating to the responsibilities of delegates to a National bahá'í convention.

of all the responsibilities resting upon a delegate, that of voting for the

members of the National Spiritual Assembly is clearly the most weighty. in

carrying out this duty, the delegate must, prayerfully and conscientiously, vote for those whom he judges best fit the qualifications that the beloved guardian has outlined for those who are to serve on Spiritual Assemblies

and, in making this choice, he must be left free from every external influ-

ence by either individual believers or bahá'í institutions. if he states that

he has difficulty in thinking of nine bahá'ís who measure up to the high

standards mentioned, he could be referred to the following passage written on behalf of the guardian to a National Spiritual Assembly on 24 October

1947:

in regard to your question about qualifications of delegates and

Assembly members: the qualifications which he outlined are really ap-185.1

185.2

185.3

185.4

185.4a

m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

□ o p l i c a b l e t o a n y o n e w e e l e c t t o a b a h á ' í o f f i c e , w h a t e v e r i t s n a t u r e . b u t

t h e s e a r e o n l y a n i n d i c a t i o n , t h e y d o n o t m e a n p e o p l e w h o d o n ' t f u l f i l l

t h e m c a n n o t b e e l e c t e d t o o f f i c e . w e m u s t a i m a s h i g h a s w e c a n . h e

d o e s n o t f e e l t h e f r i e n d s s h o u l d a t t a c h s o m u c h i m p o r t a n c e t o l i m i -

t a t i o n s — s u c h a s p e o p l e p e r h a p s n o t b e i n g a b l e t o a t t e n d A s s e m b l y o r c o n v e n t i o n m e e t i n g s , b e c a u s e i f t h e y d o , t h e n t h e f u n d a m e n t a l

c o n c e p t o f e v e r y o n e b e i n g w i l l i n g t o d o b a h á ' í s e r v i c e o n a d m i n i s t r a -

t i v e b o d i e s w i l l b e w e a k e n e d , a n d t h e f r i e n d s m a y b e t e m p t e d t o v o t e f o r t h o s e w h o b e c a u s e o f i n d e p e n d e n t m e a n s o r c i r c u m s t a n c e s i n t h e i r l i v e s a r e f r e e r t o c o m e a n d g o b u t l e s s q u a l i f i e d t o s e r v e .

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f o r a d e l e g a t e t o w a l k o u t o f t h e c o n v e n t i o n h a l l a t t h e t i m e o f t h e e l e c -

t i o n w o u l d s e e m t o i n d i c a t e a d i s d a i n f o r t h e e l e c t o r a l p r o c e s s a n d a p u b l i c

a b d i c a t i o n o f h i s r e s p o n s i b i l i t i e s , w h i c h w o u l d b e q u i t e i m p r o p e r . i t i s e n -

t i r e l y w i t h i n t h e a u t h o r i t y o f t h e N a t i o n a l S p i r i t u a l A s s e m b l y t o i n q u i r e t h e

r e a s o n f o r s u c h e x t r a o r d i n a r y b e h a v i o r , i n a s m u c h a s i t h a s t h e r e s p o n s i b i l i t y f o r t h e p r o p e r c o n d u c t o f t h e c o n v e n t i o n .

f u r t h e r m o r e , o n e o f t h e r e s p o n s i b i l i t i e s o f a d e l e g a t e i s t o r e p o r t b a c k

f r o m t h e c o n v e n t i o n t o t h e d i s t r i c t b y w h i c h h e w a s e l e c t e d . i f t h i s p a r t i c u -

l a r d e l e g a t e d o e s n o t e x p l a i n t o h i s e l e c t o r s t h e r e a s o n f o r h i s f a i l u r e t o v o t e , y o u r A s s e m b l y w o u l d b e f u l l y e n t i t l e d t o r e p o r t t h e o c c u r r e n c e t o t h e m .

w i t h l o v i n g b a h á ' í g r e e t i n g s ,

D e p a r t m e n t o f t h e s e c r e t a r i a t

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V i s i t t o t h e B a h á ' í W o r l d C e n t e r

b y t h e P r e s i d e n t o f t h e S e y c h e l l e s

[s i g n e d : T h e U n i v e r s a l H o u s e o f J u s t i c e]